

Freelancer Client Onboarding Kit: 6 Done-for-You Templates

RenWork Digital Products

1. The Welcome Email: Setting the Tone for Success

****Subject:**** Welcome aboard! [Project Name] is officially on ?

Hi [Client First Name],

It's great to have you on board. I'm thrilled to be working with [Company Name] on [Project Name].

My goal is to make this process as seamless and stress-free for you as possible, ensuring we deliver

results that exceed your expectations.

To get us started on the right foot, here is exactly what happens next:

1. ****Kickoff Questionnaire:**** I've attached a brief questionnaire (or you'll find the link below).

Please complete this by [Date, e.g., 48 hours from now]. Your answers here are the foundation of our

strategy, so please take your time to be specific.

2. ****Asset Handoff:**** Please gather any existing brand assets, logos, copy, or historical data we might need in the meantime. You can upload these to our shared drive: [Link to Shared Drive].

3. ****Timeline Review:**** I've attached our proposed project timeline. Please review it and let me know if any dates conflict with your internal deadlines.

****What you need to do right now:****

- * ☐ Fill out the Kickoff Questionnaire.
- * ☐ Grant me access to [Specific Software/Tool, e.g., Figma, WordPress, Slack].
- * ☐ Confirm your primary point of contact for final approvals.

If you have any immediate questions, just reply to this email or book a quick 15-minute call using this link: [Link to Calendar].

Looking forward to building something great together.

Best,

[Your Name]

[Your Title]

2. Project Kickoff Questionnaire: Deep-Dive Discovery

Instructions for Client: Please be as detailed as possible. Vague answers lead to vague results. Detailed answers lead to tailored, high-impact work.

1. Goals & Objectives

1. What is the single most important goal for this project? (e.g., Increase sales, improve brand perception, generate leads.)
2. How will we measure success? Please provide specific KPIs (e.g., "Increase conversion rate by 10%," "Gain 500 new subscribers").
3. What is the biggest challenge or pain point you are currently facing that this project should solve?

2. Audience & Market

4. Who is your ideal customer? Please describe their demographics (age, location, income) and psychographics (values, interests, fears).
5. Who is your main competitor? What do you like or dislike about their current approach?
6. What language or tone resonates best with your audience? (e.g., Professional, playful, urgent, empathetic.)

3. Brand Voice & Identity

7. In three words, how would you describe your brand personality? (e.g., Innovative, Trustworthy, Bold.)
8. Are there specific words or phrases your brand never uses? Please list them.
9. Can you share links to 3 websites or social media posts that exemplify the style/voice you want to emulate? Why do you like them?
10. Conversely, can you share an example of a competitor's work that you absolutely do **not** want? Why?

4. Deliverables & Scope

11. Please list every specific deliverable you expect from this project. (e.g., "5 blog posts,"

"Landing page design," "Video script.")

12. Are there any technical specifications or constraints? (e.g., Word count limits, image dimensions, file formats.)

13. Do you have existing content or design assets we should incorporate? If so, please provide links

or uploads.

14. Who is the final decision-maker for approving each deliverable? Please provide their name and

email.

****5. Logistics & Preferences****

15. What is your preferred method of communication? (Email, Slack, Phone, Video Call.)

16. What are your preferred hours for communication? (e.g., "Weekdays 9am-5pm EST.")

17. How many rounds of revisions do you anticipate needing for each deliverable?

18. What is your deadline for the final delivery? Is this date flexible or hard?

19. Are there any upcoming holidays, product launches, or internal events that might affect your availability for feedback?

20. Is there anything else I should know about your workflow or specific requirements that I haven't

asked?

3. Onboarding Checklist: Streamlining Setup

Send this to the client immediately after the welcome email. Check off items as they are completed.

****Client Actions (Required within 48 hours)****

* ☐ ****Access Granted:**** Client has granted [Your Name] admin/editor access to [List Tools: e.g., WordPress, Figma, Canva, Slack].

* ☐ ****Asset Upload:**** Client has uploaded all necessary brand assets (logos, fonts, images) to the shared folder.

* ☐ ****Questionnaire Complete:**** Client has submitted the Kickoff Questionnaire.

* ☐ ****Stakeholder Identified:**** Client has confirmed the final approver's name and email address.

* ☐ ****Payment Processed:**** Initial deposit/invoice has been paid.

****Freelancer Setup (To be completed by [Date])****

* ☐ ****Workspace Created:**** Dedicated folder structure created in [Cloud Storage] for [Project

Name].

- * [] **Tool Integration:** Client added to project-specific channels in [Communication Tool].

- * [] **Timeline Drafted:** Initial project timeline drafted based on questionnaire answers.

- * [] **Brief Compiled:** All questionnaire answers summarized into a one-page "Project Brief" for reference.

- * [] **Kickoff Call Scheduled:** 30-minute video call booked to review the brief and timeline.

4. Communication Expectations One-Pager

Our Communication Protocol

To ensure efficiency and respect for both our time, please adhere to the following guidelines:

1. Response Times

- * **Standard Response:** I aim to respond to all emails/messages within **24-48 hours** on business days.

- * **Urgent Matters:** If something is truly urgent and needs a response outside these windows, please phone or text me directly at [Phone Number].

2. Feedback & Revisions

- * **Consolidated Feedback:** Please wait to send feedback until you have reviewed the entire deliverable. Fragmented feedback (e.g., "I don't like the header" followed by "Wait, I like the header but hate the footer") leads to inefficiency and delays.

- * **Revision Limits:** The contract includes [Number] rounds of revisions per deliverable. These are for adjustments based on the initial brief.

- * **Scope Changes:** If feedback fundamentally changes the direction of the project (e.g., changing from a minimalist design to a maximalist design), this is considered a scope change and will require a new quote and timeline adjustment.

3. Feedback Format

- * Please provide specific, actionable feedback. Instead of "Make it pop," try "The headline is too small; please increase the font size by 20% and use the primary brand color."

- * Use comments directly on the file (e.g., Figma comments, Word track changes) where possible to avoid misinterpretation.

4. Status Updates

- * I will send a brief status update every [Frequency, e.g., Friday] outlining what was

completed, what is in progress, and what is next.

- * Please flag any internal delays in your feedback process immediately so we can adjust the timeline proactively.

5. Project Timeline Template

Note: Dates are placeholders. Adjust based on project complexity.

****Phase 1: Discovery & Strategy (Week 1)****

- * ****Day 1-2:**** Client completes Kickoff Questionnaire & grants access.
- * ****Day 3:**** Freelancer compiles Project Brief.
- * ****Day 4:**** ****Milestone:**** 30-Minute Kickoff Call to align on goals and brief.
- * ****Day 5:**** Strategy outline drafted.

****Phase 2: Production (Weeks 2-3)****

- * ****Week 2:**** Initial drafts created.
- * ****Day 9:**** ****Client Review Window Opens:**** Client receives first draft. *Client must provide feedback within 3 business days.*
- * ****Week 3:**** Revisions implemented based on first round of feedback.

****Phase 3: Refinement & Finalization (Week 4)****

- * ****Day 14:**** ****Milestone:**** Second draft delivered.
- * ****Day 15-16:**** Final revisions.
- * ****Day 17:**** ****Client Review Window Opens:**** Final approval requested. *Client must provide final approval within 2 business days.*
- * ****Day 19:**** Final files exported and organized.

****Phase 4: Delivery & Handoff (Week 4, End)****

- * ****Day 20:**** Final deliverables sent to client.
- * ****Day 21:**** Project wrap-up call (optional) & final invoice sent.

6. Scope Creep Response Script

*Scenario: The client requests a task that is not in the original contract (e.g